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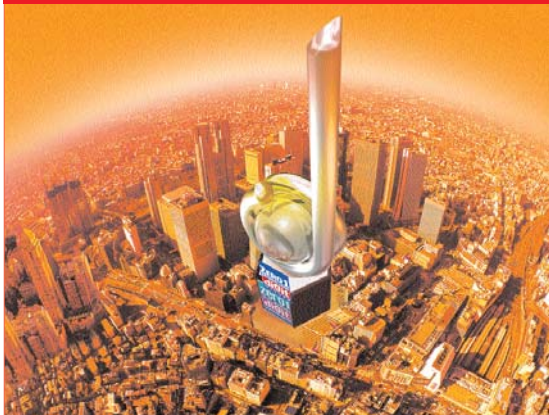
18
Archana Puran Singh seems to think tech is “a pain in the a***”

18
Something interesting brewing—with MS *not* locking horns with Linux

19
About IE7's much-talked-about anti-phishing

24
What's ALIPR?

Cover Story



26 The Digit Zero1 Awards 2006

A round-up of sorts; an award ceremony of sorts. Here are the best tech products to have come from manufacturers' stables in 2006. We speak with authority.

In Sight

58 Will Wii Rock You?

The Wii and its controllers seem fascinating upon first look. But how much will the console do for Nintendo and its lost crown?

Digital Passion

Lead Feature

55 You're Being Watched

You know the latest “trend” with camera phones and such: explicit videos turning up on the Net! But have you ever thought of *yourself* becoming a victim?

Tomorrow

64 In Search Of Order

As we cough our way through clouds of smog and avoid toe-trimming taxis, we wish deeply for technologies that will ameliorate the situation



First Hand

68 Leading The Charge

There are whiz-kids, and then there are whiz-kids. Shadab Ansari built a robot that can actually help our troops in the line of fire

Contents Magazine

Digital Tools

Lead Feature

72 The Geek's Pickings

Here's our yearly round-up of what tech delivered in 2006. We spot some trends, blame some entities, name some broken promises, and thank some boffins around the world for having made the world a more interesting place



Net Gain

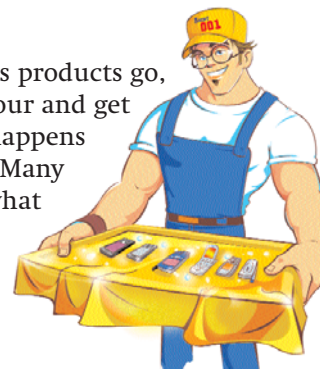
106 Space.com & LiveScience.com

Many of us surf for tech news and the latest developments—and also just to kill time. Lazy, pointless hours of “idle surfing.” Put some of those decadent hours to good use, rekindling your astronautical and chemistry-experimental passions you had as a boy. We think these sites are worth every bit of the time you spend there. Kids might just develop new interests

Agent001

102 Ringing In The New

Agent001, our alpha geek as products go, decides to do himself a favour and get a new cell phone. He also happens to be reasonably unbiased. Many of you will want to know what exactly he was looking for in a phone, and what he finally bought—turn to the page!



80 Bazaar

Our regular section on (mostly) good products that have made it to store-shelves. Featuring a cool mouse, a nice Flash drive, a couple of interesting LCD displays—and not to forget, the iPod nano 4GB. And more.

104 Know More About... 4G

The fourth generation of wireless communications, or 4G as it is called, has no definition! Find out what it's about, who's talking about it, and why